



Minutes Without Memory

Validating a Reflection Room’s Visit-Minutes Log Against Next-Month Incident Recurrence

Mirela Hanke · Joost Nwosu — School of Continuous Improvement

The problem

Hall wardens have logged reflection-room minutes since 2019, filed upward as a de-escalation outcome. Whether that time tracks what happens to a resident afterward has never been checked against the incident register it feeds.

Research questions

- Does visit-length predict a resident’s return to next month’s incident register?
- Do visit-minutes distributions differ by reappearance?
- Does the reported figure track resolution, or just occupancy?

Study design

- n = 214 visits · 9 halls of residence · Jan 2025-Jun 2026
- Visit-minutes matched to next month’s incident register by resident ID
- Reappearance threshold pre-registered, any incident, any severity

Findings

Median visit length was near-identical by outcome (18 vs 17 minutes); a rank-sum comparison found no reliable separation between the two distributions.



Median reflection-room visit: 18 minutes (reappeared within 30 days, n = 71) vs 17 minutes (did not, n = 143); Mann-Whitney U, p = 0.58, Jan 2025-Jun 2026.

Interpretation & where next

The reflection room’s own log can’t distinguish a resolved visit from a deferred one — minutes travel upward as a de-escalation figure regardless of what follows. Next: test a 90-day recurrence window instead of 30, and check whether visit length predicts anything at the individual level.

Selected references

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We thank the residential-life staff who maintain the reflection-room log across all nine halls. Ethics: de-identified visit and incident records only; no resident named in the log or this analysis.

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“The room logs minutes. It was never asked to log what happens next.”

n = 214 visits, 18-month audit, no reliable link to next-month recurrence